

Toddler Potty Training Resistance — Action Checklist

PRINT THIS PAGE AND KEEP IT SOMEWHERE VISIBLE

ASSESS YOUR CHILD'S READINESS

- ☐ **Assess Readiness:** Check if your child stays dry for 1-2 hours during the day, as this signals the physical bladder capacity that potty training requires to work at all.
- ☐ **Assess Readiness:** Track your child's bowel movement schedule for several days to identify predictable patterns that give you a reliable window to intercept potty behavior.
- ☐ **Assess Readiness:** Verify your child can follow simple two-step instructions like "sit on the potty" and "tell me when you're done," since this language processing ability is required for training.
- ☐ **Assess Readiness:** Count how many of the five readiness signs your child shows and stop formal training if they have three or fewer, because pushing before readiness creates power struggles that set you back further.

BUILD READINESS WHILE YOU WAIT

- ☐ **Build Readiness:** Start using correct anatomical terms like pee, poop, potty, and toilet consistently so your child has the vocabulary needed to communicate their needs when training begins.
- ☐ **Build Readiness:** Place a potty chair in the bathroom and let your child sit on it fully clothed first, then undressed, with zero pressure or commentary about training to build comfortable familiarity.
- ☐ **Build Readiness:** Read simple children's books about potty training and let your child observe older siblings or parents using the toilet to normalize the concept without creating anxiety or obligation.
- ☐ **Build Readiness:** Monitor diaper wetness patterns throughout the day for at least a week to identify when your child naturally stays dry longest, which reveals their actual bladder capacity window.

MATCH METHOD TO TEMPERAMENT

- ☐ **Match Method:** Identify whether your child is truly resistant to potty training or simply not developmentally ready yet, because the solution for each problem is completely different.
 - ☐ **Match Method:** Watch for sensory sensitivities such as fear of toilet sounds, cold seats, or uncomfortable positioning that may be causing avoidance rather than true resistance or stubbornness.
 - ☐ **Match Method:** Compare your previous method's design to your child's specific temperament profile, since a method that works for cooperative toddlers often fails entirely for strong-willed or anxious ones.
 - ☐ **Match Method:** Schedule a pediatric appointment if your child shows multiple readiness signs but still refuses consistently, to rule out physical issues like constipation, bladder dysfunction, or sensory processing differences.
-

Companion to the full guide in your Lemon Squeezy library — check off each item as you complete it.